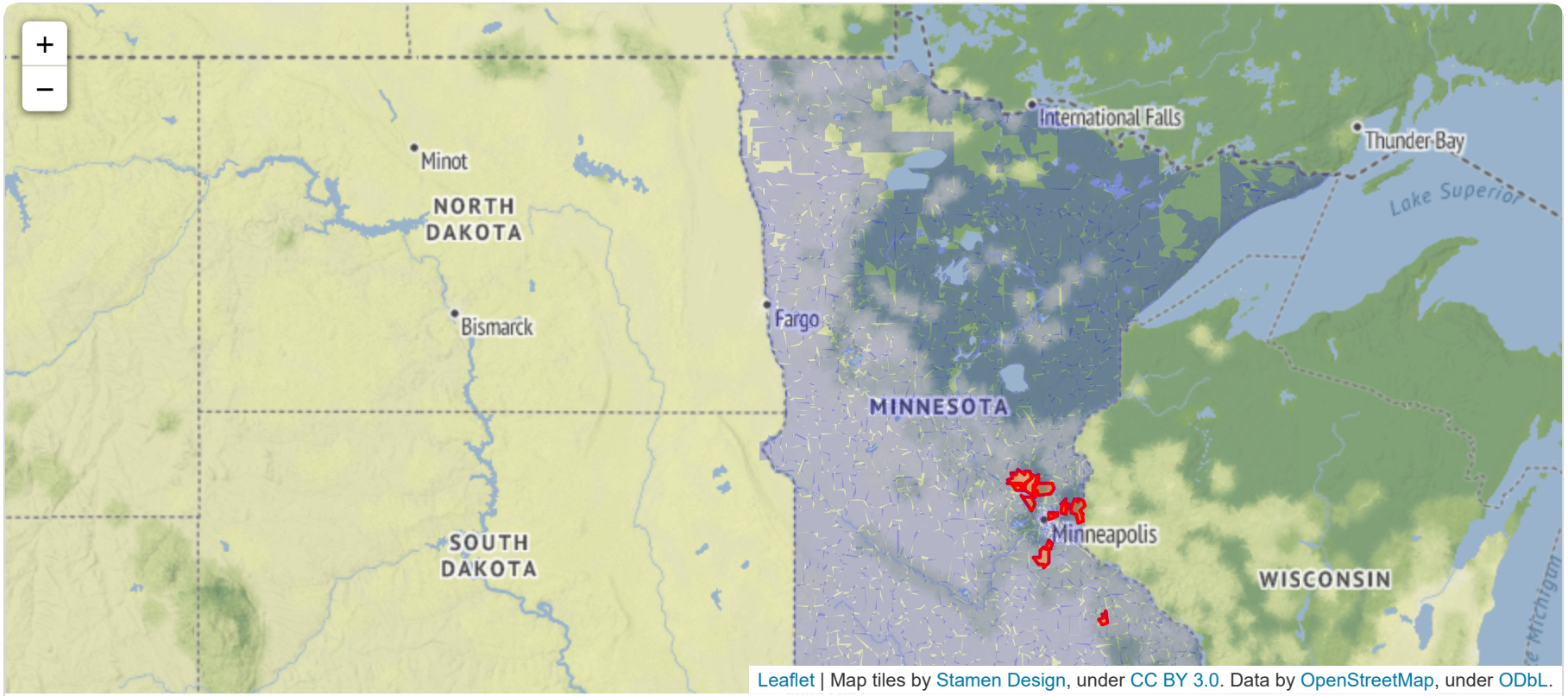


Local Account Intelligence

HEARING AID CENTERS

in the state of Minnesota

Know the Market



Top zip codes for consumer spending on hearing aids

[Source: 2025 EASI Demographics]

Hearing Aid Centers

Includes category intelligence for retailers of hearing aids, providers of audiology tests and services.

Industry Background

Primary NAICS Code: *456199*
All Other Health and Personal Care Retailers

Primary SIC Code: *5999*
Miscellaneous Retail Stores, NEC (hearing aids and artificial limbs)

Industry Intel

Hearing aid vendors fit patients with hearing-assist devices. These businesses may also sell other products that target consumers with hearing loss. Some hearing aid centers are staffed with audiologists who test patients and recommend the right type of hearing aids. Audiologists generally have post-college graduate program training in this special field and many have doctorates.

People experiencing hearing loss may talk to their primary healthcare provider, then get a referral to an ENT physician, and/or get a hearing test. Some initially go to hearing healthcare provider, such as an audiologist or hearing instrument specialist. Note that as of October 2022, the FDA made access to over the counter (OTC) hearing aids available for direct purchase without the need for a medical exam.

There are about 15,000 audiologist businesses in the U.S. with an estimated overall revenue of $44.7 billion.

The U.S. market for hearing aids and audiology devices is worth an estimated $6.0 billion. Specifically, hearing aid centers have annual revenue of approximately $3.5 billion and total approximately 5,100 businesses.

Hearing aid centers target consumers ages 60 and over, and this population continues to grow. Hearing aid vendors have recently begun marketing to family members of hearing loss patients to increase sales. Key complaints about the devices include price and difficulty with use.

Major manufacturers dominate the manufacturing business and work through distributors to get to retailers and medical offices.

If new technology evolves that reduces cost and makes devices more effective, this market might grow because the population of the United States continues to age.

[Sources: audiologyonline.com, n.d. Web. 9 Sep. 2026; "Hearing Aid Stores." IBISWorld.com, Apr. 2025. Web. 9 Sep. 2026; hearingreview.com,n.d. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.]

Items commonly offered by Hearing Aid Centers

- Free trial periods
- Warranties
- Batteries
- In-home service
- Most insurance plans accepted
- Outpatient counseling
- Wireless aids
- Free cleaning and hearing tests
- Speech pathologists
- Repairs
- Custom impressions

Executive Summary

4.8% of US adults said "Hearing aids, batteries or service" when asked "When it comes to health and wellness, I intend or expect to pay for these items in the next 12 months..."

There is 1 active Media Sales Opportunity for and Miracle-Ear

Top sales months for Hearing Aid Centers are: November, December.

The Annual Advertising/Marketing Budget is Approximately **5.91%** of retail sales - retail-retail stores, nec

There is at least one co-op advertising plan available: Beltone Electronics Corporation

51.1% of U.S. adults believe that doctors and physicians are credible in what they say and do, and have their best interest at heart.

You can confidently lead with mailbox advertising as a conversion driver, not just an awareness tactic. **69.2% of Hearing Aid Shoppers** took action after seeing an ads/coupons in your mailbox in the past year.

Source: Exclusive research from AdMall, SalesFuel and our reliable partners - not available from AI.

Know the Opportunities

Limited-Time Opportunities+Shareables

SHAREABLE INSIGHTS

52% of Seniors Miss Key Moments Due to Hearing Challenges

> More than half (52%) of U.S. adults aged 60 and older report missing or struggling to fully experience important moments due to hearing difficulties. This finding highlights the pervasive impact of hearing loss on meaningful social interactions among older adults.

Share any of the 7 findings like this from the Hearing Experience with your local accounts and prospects.

SHAREABLE INSIGHTS

Are Employers Overconfident? Workforce Challenges Loom

> Operational needs, rather than pure optimism, are motivating companies to hire, with 53% citing increased volumes of work as the reason for headcount growth. The focus on filling newly created positions and employee turnover reflects strategic workforce management amidst a competitive labor market.

Share any of the 10 findings like this from the Express Employment Professionals with your local accounts and prospects.

Upcoming National Event Tie-Ins

- Better Hearing & Speech Month

- National Audiology Awareness Month
- Protect Your Hearing Month

Opportunities+Challenges

To stand apart from competitors, some of these businesses are "unbundling" by itemizing the costs of the devices, accessories, and services and billing for them separately as they occur.

Source: "Unbundling Hearing Aid Sales." ASHA.org, n.d. Web. Mar. 2024.

Growing demand for education and support creates an opportunity to help OTC users navigate hearing loss and device use, particularly those experiencing hearing loss for the first time without professional guidance.

Source: "Hearing Aid Adoption in the OTC Hearing Aid Era: Market Trends and Consumer Insights from MarkeTrak 2025." thieme-connect.com, 2025. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.

Clinics could offer OTC hearing aid onboarding packages that include hearing screenings, device optimization and follow-up support, creating additional revenue opportunities while establishing relationships that may lead to future conversion to traditional devices.

Source: "Hearing Aid Adoption in the OTC Hearing Aid Era: Market Trends and Consumer Insights from MarkeTrak 2025." thieme-connect.com, 2025. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.

Operators may want to emphasize the importance of individualized fittings as consumers cannot self-diagnose their own hearing assessment and improper settings can further deteriorate hearing loss.

Source: "The Importance of Customized Hearing Aid Fittings." Kirschaudiology.com, 28 Sept. 2023. Web. Mar. 2024.

Industry professionals predict demand for rechargeable hearing aids and batteries to grow, as more consumers become aware of these products.

Source: "10 Best Hearing Aids of March 2024: Experts Reviewed." Noca.org, 1 Mar. 2024. Web. Mar. 2024.

Telehealth, otherwise known as teleaudiology in this field, is a tool that can be utilized for online hearing screening. This could be attractive to consumers in rural communities.

Sources: "Looking Ahead to 2024 and a More Nuanced View of the Hearing Care Market." Hearinghealthmatter.org, 26 Dec. 2023. Web. Mar. 2024.; "Increase Revenue with OTC Hearing Aid Sales: A Guide to Understanding OTCs and Using Online Hearing Screening and Marketing." Shoebox.md, n.d. Web. Mar. 2024.

OTC devices may serve as an entry point into the broader hearing care market, particularly for younger and first-time users, creating opportunities for audiologists to become trusted guides throughout the hearing care journey.

Source: "Hearing Aid Adoption in the OTC Hearing Aid Era: Market Trends and Consumer Insights from MarkeTrak 2025." thieme-connect.com, 2025. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.

Cost continues to be a barrier to use for many hearing-impaired consumers.

Source: "20Q: Hearing Aid Adoption – What Marketrak Surveys are Telling Us." Audiologyonline.com, 13 Mar. 2023. Web. Mar. 2024.

These businesses are still battling the association of hearing aids with old age, which is likely deterring many adults from hearing aid use.

Source: "20Q: Hearing Aid Adoption – What MarkeTrak Surveys are Telling Us." Audiologyonline.com, 13 Mar. 2023. Web. Mar. 2024.

Direct audio coupling to hearing aids using Bluetooth or Android's ASHA have enhanced the versatility and compatibility of these devices for end users.

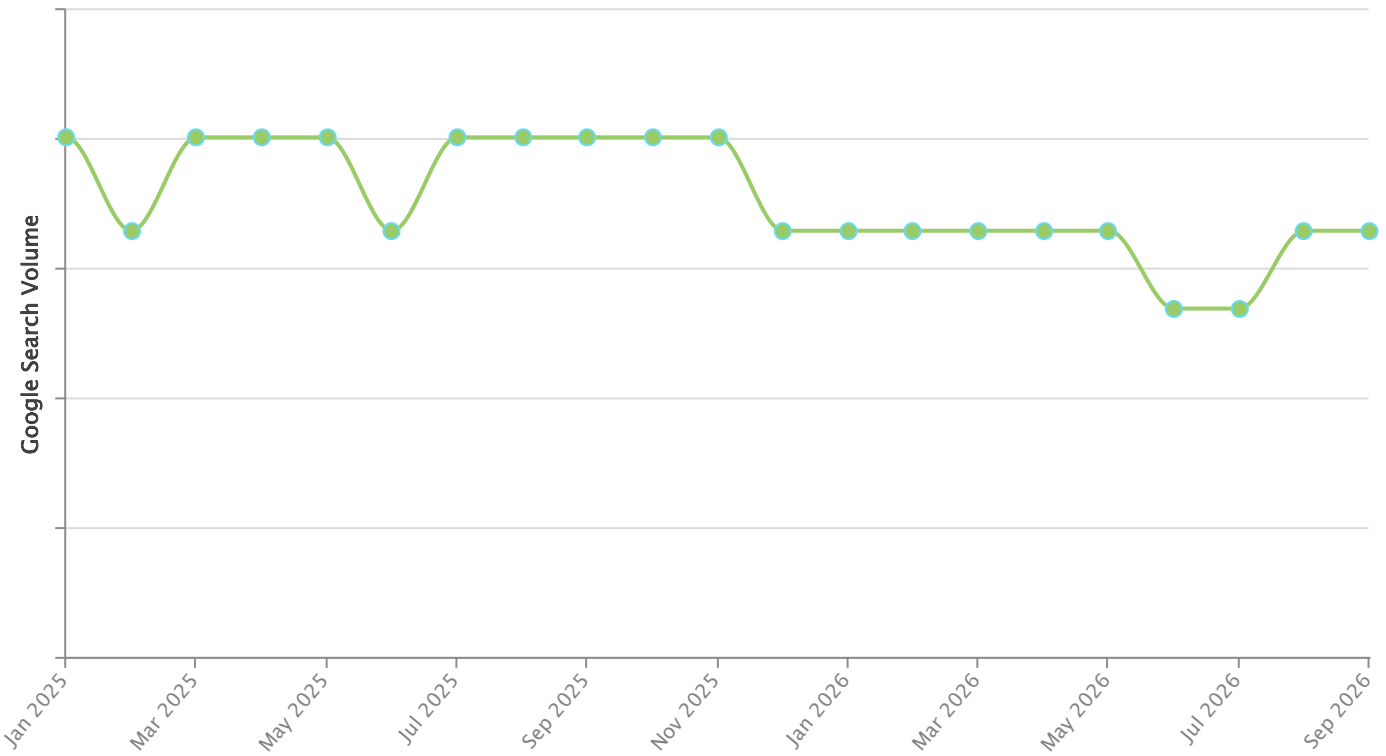
Source: "OTC Hearing Aids: Access, Affordability, and Advancements." Hearingreview.com, 25 Oct. 2023. Web. Mar. 2024.

Discovery Questions

- What is your current mix of revenue from device sales vs ongoing services, and how might shifting towards more service-oriented offerings affect your financials and staffing?
- Which promotional or marketing channels have delivered your best new patient acquisition costs (CPA), and where do you believe customer acquisition is constrained, not just budget?
- How do you measure long-term patient satisfaction or success (e.g., return visits, word-of-mouth referrals, retention), and which attributes do your patients most frequently praise or criticize?

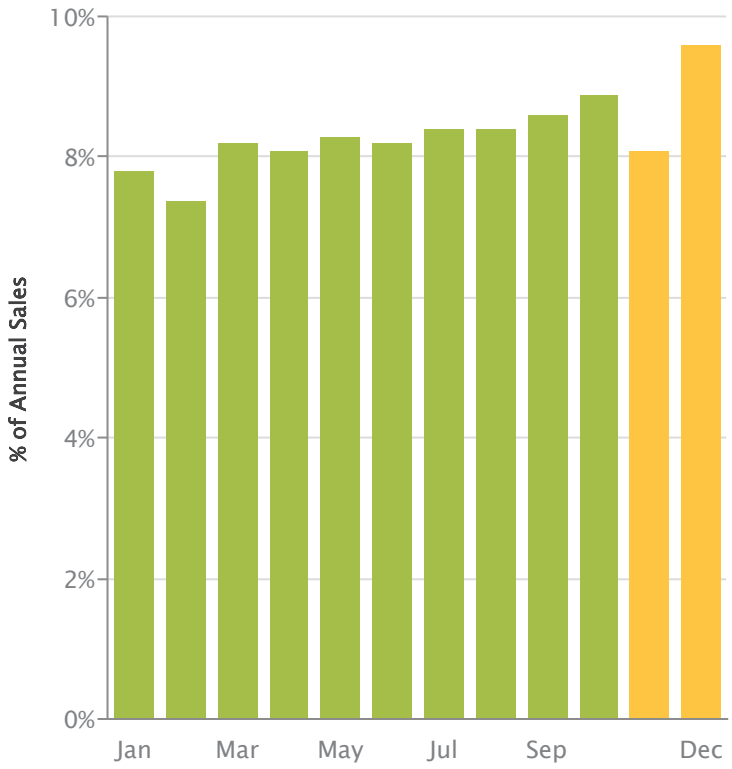
Know the Category

Peak Interest Months



Graph displays the trend line of search volume for this industry over the last 12 months. Source: DataforSEO November 02, 2026

Peak Sales Months/Seasons



Calendar Month	% of Annual Sales
January	7.8%
February	7.4%
March	8.2%
April	8.1%
May	8.3%

Calendar Month	% of Annual Sales
June	8.2%
July	8.4%
August	8.4%
September	8.6%
October	8.9%
November	8.1%
December	9.6%

In 2025, sales were highest in November and December for health and personal care stores.
[Source: "Estimates of Monthly Retail and Food Services Sales by Kind of Business: 2025." Monthly Retail Trade Survey. Census.gov. U.S. Census Bureau, Mar. 2026. Web. 21 Apr. 2026.]

Annual Advertising/Marketing Budget

Approximately **5.91%** of retail sales - retail-retail stores, nec
[Source:" Ad to Sales Ratios." Schonfeld & Associates, 2026.]

Top Advertising Media Used

Traditional media:

- Television
- Print
- Direct mail
- Outdoor
- Patient testimonials

Digital media:

- Social media (Facebook, Instagram)
- Video
- SEO
- Online directories
- Online reviews

[Sources: audiologist.org, n.d. Web. 9 Sep. 2026; "Audiology Clinic Marketing: Patient Growth Playbook." buzzbox.com, 12 May 2026. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.]

Digital Video Ideas for Hearing Aid Centers



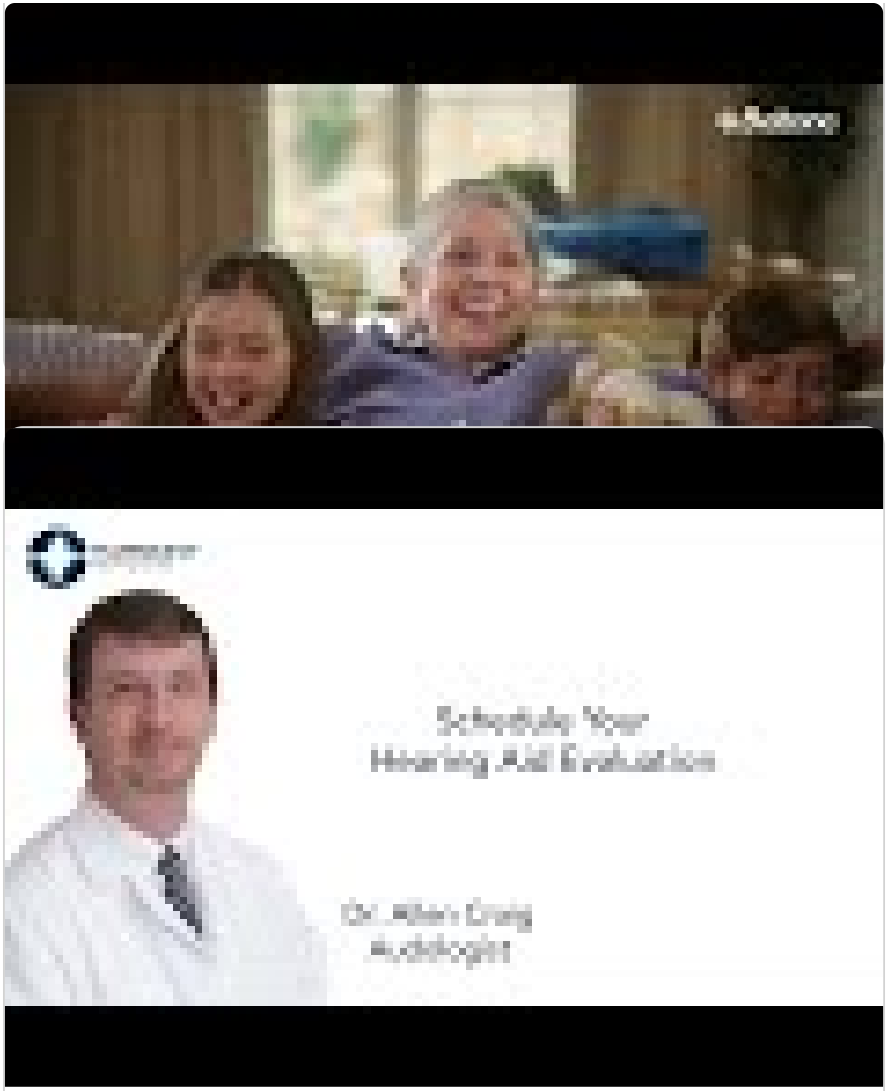
Country Roads Audiology and Hearing Aid Center
Country Roads Audiology and Hearing Aid Center



Clear Choice Hearing & Balance Clear Choice Hearing & Balance



The Hearing Center of Ohio The Hearing Center of Ohio



Hearing Aids Jonesboro

Know the Customers

Value of a New Customer

Hearing Aid Centers in the state of Minnesota

1

New Customer

$7,023

10

New Customers

$70,230

25

New Customers

$175,575

New customer revenue over a 10-year period for consumers. Does not reflect business accounts.

SOURCE: 2025 SalesFuel, EASI Demographics, US Consumer Expenditure Survey

Target Customers

Hearing loss is most common among older adults, affecting 1 in 3 people ages 65–74 and nearly half of those 75 and older.
[Source: "Hearing Health."NCOA.org, n.d. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.]

The following adults have disabling hearing loss:

- 45 to 54 - 5%
- 55 to 64 - 10%
- 65 to 74 - 22%
- 75+ - 55%

[Source: "Quick Statistics About Hearing, Balance, & Dizziness." NIDCD.NIH.gov, 20 Sep. 2024. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.]

Traditional hearing aid adoption is highest among adults 65 and older, while OTC adoption is highest among those 34 and younger. OTC buyers are more likely to be first-time purchasers (70% vs. 58%), but traditional hearing aid owners are more likely to use their devices daily (69% vs. 55%). Among OTC owners planning to purchase new hearing aids, more than half expect to buy in person from a healthcare professional (HCP), and 60% of OTC owners who did not receive professional assistance believe it would have been beneficial.
[Source: "Research Quick Takes Volume 10: An Update on OTC Hearing Aids." audiologyonline.com, 17 Oct. 2025. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.]

Prescription hearing aid owners most often purchase from a clinic or hearing center (84%), while 67% of OTC hearing aid owners purchase completely online or from a retailer or pharmacy, either online or in person. However, 31% of OTC buyers purchase from a clinic or hearing center, and many OTC owners report receiving professional guidance or assistance despite no professional assistance being required.
[Source: "MarkeTrak 2025: Consumer Perspectives on Hearing Health in an Evolving Market." thieme-connect.com, 2025. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.]

OTC hearing aid users tend to be younger, more likely to be BIPOC and have lower incomes, while traditional hearing aid users are typically older, White, college-educated and retired.

Traditional hearing aid users show stronger repurchase intent, with 61% planning to repurchase within four years versus 43% of OTC users. However, 38% of current OTC users plan to switch to traditional hearing aids for their next purchase, positioning OTC devices as a potential entry point into the broader hearing healthcare market.
[Source: "Hearing Aid Adoption in the OTC Hearing Aid Era: Market Trends and Consumer Insights from MarkeTrak 2025." thieme-connect.com, 2025. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.]

Target Customers by Mile Radius

Most customers are drawn from a 30 mile radius.

(national average)
In densely populated areas, the market will be smaller and for rural areas the market will be larger.
[Sources: Abbott Hearing Aid Centers and Knipe Hearing Aid Centers, Inc. GoSmith.com; Premier Hearing Centers. Stark.GoLocal247.com.]

Top Factors People Consider When Choosing This Type Of Account

- Cost
- Modern tech features (Bluetooth capability, discreet designs, high-definition natural sound
- Aesthetic design choices, like color
- Audiologist support
- Risk-free trial period
- Long battery life

Consumers may look for audiologists certified by the American Speech-Language-Hearing Association, the American Academy of Audiology or the National Board for Certification of Hearing Instrument Sciences.

Professional recommendations strongly influence hearing aid purchases: 68% of traditional hearing aid users acted on a hearing care provider's recommendation, compared with 46% of OTC users. Among repeat purchasers, 69% cited professional guidance as a key decision factor.
[Source: "Research Quick Takes Volume 10: An Update on OTC Hearing Aids." audiologyonline.com, 17 Oct. 2025. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.]

Recommendations and referrals were also the strongest influence on where consumers visited or checked a company (66%), followed by convenience and promotions/price (52% each), trustworthiness (40%), awareness/familiarity (39%) and advertising (24%). Insurance company referrals influenced 13% of respondents, highlighting the role of financial considerations in provider selection.

Of those influenced by promotion or price, insurance coverage was an important consideration for 25%. Coverage mattered more for traditional hearing aid purchasers (26%) than OTC purchasers (10%). OTC buyers were more price-sensitive, with 27% citing special deals or discounts versus 13% of prescription buyers, and 28% citing the cheapest hearing aid versus 7% of prescription buyers.

When it comes to choosing a device, buyers say that financial factors were the strongest influence on hearing aid selection, cited by 69% of respondents, followed by product quality or technology (65%), positive service or purchasing experiences (62%), positive tests or trials demonstrating need (57%) and value-added benefits such as satisfaction guarantees (38%).

[Source: "Financial Influences Linked to Hearing Aid Purchases." thieme-connect.com, 2025. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.]

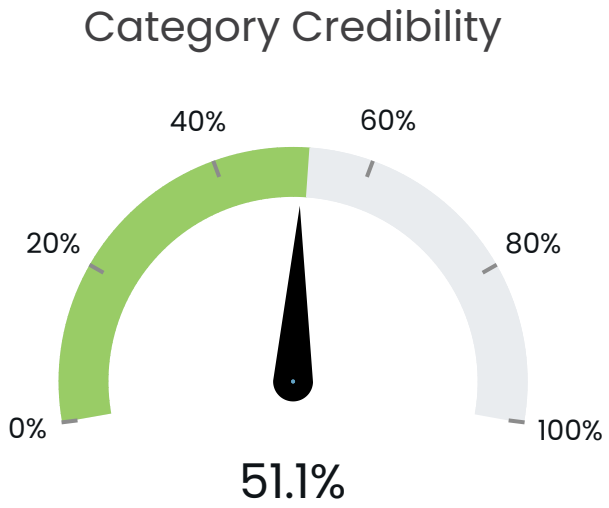
OTC BUYERS

Brand appears to play a larger role in OTC purchases: about twice as many OTC owners as prescription owners had a brand in mind before purchase, and OTC owners were twice as likely to purchase that intended brand (16% vs. 8%). More owners also report hearing aids with wireless capability, rechargeability and volume control, supporting a better user experience.

Professional recommendation is a key influence for 68% of traditional hearing aid users versus 46% of OTC users. OTC buyers are more influenced by price, convenience and online/social media marketing, reflecting a more self-directed purchasing process.
[Source: "MarkeTrak 2025: Consumer Perspectives on Hearing Health in an Evolving Market." thieme-connect.com, 2025. Web. 9 Sep. 2026.]

Category Trust+Credibility

> *51.1% of U.S. Adults believe the marketing practices of doctors and physicians are credible*



	Audience	All Respondents	Difference
65+	**28.7%**	21.6%	**+33%**
45-54	16.4%	15.8%	+4%
55-64	18.4%	18.5%	-1%
35-44	16%	18.2%	-12%
18-24	8.4%	9.6%	-12%
25-34	12.2%	16.6%	-27%

"More likely" or "less likely" than the average U.S. adult 18+.

Credibility - and whether a person has it or not - determines who you trust for guidance and information you use to make decisions in your everyday life. The four components of credibility for any human being are (1) being known, (2) being likable, (3) being helpful, and (4) being trustworthy. Credibility is gained (or lost) by what one says, how they say it, what they do and, finally, what others say about them. Having credibility also requires having others' best interests at heart.

SOURCE: 2026 State of Credibility 2026 Methodology

Trust Drivers

48.9% of U.S. adults **do not indicate a belief that the marketing** of doctors and physicians is credible. The following responses are from this audience of consumers.

> *What are the best ways for a company to demonstrate their credibility, trustworthiness and value through their marketing practices?*

Marketing Practice	Audience
Showing real customers and authentic experiences rather than overly polished or staged advertising	59.1%
Being transparent about what their product or service can and cannot do	59.1%
Making pricing, fees and terms easy to find without having to dig for them	50.8%
Clearly disclosing when their content is sponsored, paid or AI-generated	46%
Responding publicly and personally to negative reviews rather than ignoring them	40.3%
Showing the real people behind the business rather than hiding behind a brand	34.2%
Being visibly involved in and giving back to their community	33.8%
Being findable and well-represented across Google, AI search and review platforms	24.9%
Emailing, calling and/or texting me less often	17.9%
Displaying third-party recognition such as industry awards, certifications, accreditations, or media coverage	16.7%

> *How do you tell if a company you've never heard of before is legitimate?*

Vetting Method	Audience
I search for them on Google or another search engine.	53.4%
I look for reviews on sites like Yelp, Trustpilot or Google Reviews.	47.3%
I ask friends, family or colleagues if they've heard of them.	41.8%
I check their Better Business Bureau rating or complaints.	37.1%
I ask myself if the offer seems too good to be true.	35.2%
I check for their professional-looking website with a physical address and phone number.	34%
I look for industry certifications, association memberships or if they're licensed in my state.	31.6%
If I have any doubts, I simply move on and look for someone else.	30.6%
I check their social media presence to see how active, responsive and authentic they are.	28.1%
I search for them on an AI assistant like ChatGPT.	14.1%

SOURCE: 2026 State of Credibility 2026 Methodology

Interests+Attitudes

Additional intelligence for audiences often targeted by hearing aid centers from AudienceSCAN®

Seniors

Hearing Aid Shoppers

Healthcare Needs

Hearing trouble

Digital Usage: Hearing Aid Shoppers

> *4.8% of U.S. adults said "Hearing aids, batteries or service" when asked: "When it comes to health and wellness, I intend or expect to pay for these items in the next 12 months....."*

111%
More likely to

Read a Blog Every Day

(55.5% of audience)

21%
More likely to

Research a product or service on a local store website before purchasing

(31.5% of audience)

6%
Less likely to

Go Past First Search Page Results

(19.8% of audience)

I enjoy sharing my experiences with products/stores on social media

Rank		Audience	All U.S.	Difference
1	If I have a GOOD experience with a product or store, I will usually share it with my friends using social media or by posting a positive review	**36.2**	26.4	37.0
2	If I have a BAD experience with a product or store, I will usually share it using social media or by posting a negative review	25.3	16.6	**52.0**

"Hearing Aid Shoppers" are defined by 2026 AudienceSCAN®
"More likely" or "less likely" than the average U.S. adult 18+.
SOURCE: 2026 AudienceSCAN®

B2C Advertising Response: Hearing Aid Shoppers

> *When have you last seen/heard an advertisement of this type that led you to take action?*

Past 30 Days

Rank		Regional Audience	Entire Region	Differen
1	Ads/Coupons in your mailbox	**41.6%**	29.9%	**+39%**
2	Mobile phone app or text message	**45.1%**	36.6%	+23%
3	Advertising circulars in your mailbox or inserted in the newspaper	38.6%	27.2%	**+42%**
4	Television (traditional, including cable or satellite subscription)	**41.1%**	34.7%	+18%
5	Ad on a social network	**40.6%**	35.9%	+13%
6	Newspaper (print, online, mobile or tablet)	32.6%	23.5%	**+39%**
7	Emailed ad or newsletter	35.8%	28.6%	+25%
8	Text link ad on a website	34.7%	27.3%	+27%
9	Streaming TV advertising (such as Hulu, Pluto TV or YouTube TV)	**39.4%**	36.7%	+7%

Past Year

Rank		Regional Audience	Entire Region	Difference
1	Ads/Coupons in your mailbox	**69.2%**	56.2%	**+23%**
2	Advertising circulars in your mailbox or inserted in the newspaper	**66%**	52.2%	**+26%**
3	Television (traditional, including cable or satellite subscription)	**68.6%**	60%	+14%
4	Ad on search results pages (like on Google, Yahoo or Bing)	**67.6%**	59.7%	+13%
5	Newspaper (print, online, mobile or tablet)	59.5%	44.7%	**+33%**
6	Magazine (print, online, mobile or on tablet)	58.4%	44%	**+33%**
7	Mobile phone app or text message	**64.9%**	58.1%	+12%
8	Emailed ad or newsletter	62.4%	52.8%	+18%
9	Streaming TV advertising (such as	63.3%	58.2%	+9%

Rank		Regional Audience	Entire Region	Difference
10	Ad on search results pages (like on Google, Yahoo or Bing)	38.8%	35.8%	+8%
11	Magazine (print, online, mobile or on tablet)	30.2%	21.5%	**+40%**
12	Ad that plays before or during the video you want to watch	35.4%	31.1%	+14%
13	Online display ads (banners and pop-up ads)	34.9%	30%	+16%
14	Radio (over-the-air, online, mobile or tablet)	31.1%	25.5%	+22%
15	Ad on a podcast	29.1%	22.7%	+28%
16	Ads at movie theater	28.2%	21.5%	**+31%**
17	Outdoor ad/sign/billboard/transit	29.5%	23.6%	+25%

Rank		Regional Audience	Entire Region	Difference
	Hulu, Pluto TV or YouTube TV)			
10	Ad on a social network	63.3%	59.2%	+7%
11	Online display ads (banners and pop-up ads)	60.3%	53.1%	+14%
12	Radio (over-the-air, online, mobile or tablet)	57.4%	47.6%	**+21%**
13	Ad that plays before or during the video you want to watch	59%	53.5%	+10%
14	Text link ad on a website	56.9%	49.5%	+15%
15	Outdoor ad/sign/billboard/transit	55%	46.1%	+19%
16	Ads at movie theater	49.1%	42.6%	+15%
17	Ad on a podcast	48.9%	42.5%	+15%

SOURCE: 2026 AudienceSCAN®

* % total may not equal 100% because audience could select more than one answer to this question.

Did You Know

> ***Hearing Aid Shoppers*** *are* ***25% more likely*** *to take action by checking a company's blog to check reviews on the advertiser after seeing an ad.*

> *When* ***Hearing Aid Shoppers*** *search a business online,* ***32.9%*** *usually have a company name in mind.*

> ***Hearing Aid Shoppers*** *are* ***30% more likely*** *to check a company's blog to evaluate their expertise and subject knowledge than the average U.S. adult.*

> ***Hearing Aid Shoppers*** *in the U.S. are* ***134%*** *more likely to participate in* ***playing esports*** *than the average adult.*

SOURCE: 2026 AudienceSCAN®

Know the Competition

Major Account Competitors

Hearing Aid Centers

Miracle-Ear Franchisees Can Tap 10% Local Budget to Advertise Waterproof Hearing Aids

Miracle-Ear franchisees have a big opportunity to capture business by promoting the BLISS+ CIC, a waterproof device that features eight layers of protection against water, sweat and dust. Franchisees must spend at least 10% of net sales on local advertising. They must also contribute to the national marketing fund at $76 per wholesale unit and $25 per refurbished retail unit.

Top Major Accounts and Franchises

Hearing Aid Centers

Miracle-Ear

39 locations in this market

HearUSA

4 locations in this market

Local Competitors

Hearing Aid Centers

Other similar or related local account types to hearing aid centers in your market.

- Doctors
- Hospitals, Specialty
- Doctors - Ear, Nose and Throat (ENT)
- Drugstores/Pharmacies

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